Q. WHO IS INDIA'S NO. 1 MALE SINGER?

1. **SONU NIGAM** — 16 [25.5]
2. **ARIJIT SINGH** — 13.4 [31.8]
3. **JUBIN NAUTIYAL** — 10.2 [1.8]
4. **HARIHARAN** — 7.9 [N.A.]
5. **PAWAN SINGH** — 5.3 [N.A.]



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Q. WHO IS INDIA'S NO. 1 FEMALE SINGER?

1. **SHREYA GHOSHAL** — 24 [32.8]
2. **ALKA YAGNIK** — 23.2 [N.A.]
3. **NEHA KAKKAR** — 7 [11.8]
4. **SUNIDHI CHAUHAN** — 6 [2.9]
5. **SHILPA RAO** — 3.5 [N.A.]



AFP



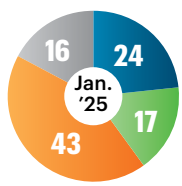


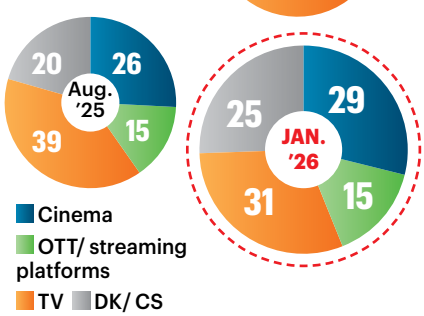




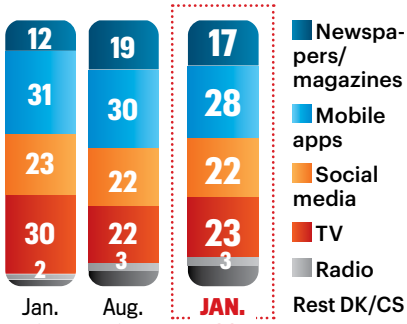
Rest, others & DK/CS; all figures in %; Jan. '26 figures in red, Aug. '25 in []

Q. Where do you prefer watching films?





Q. Where do you get your news from?



actor-turned-CM.

If Vijay and four other southern stars featured among the top 10 heroes, there was a similar story for the heroines too. While Deepika Padukone held on to the top spot, Rashmika Mandanna, Sai Pallavi and Nayanthara, all of whom have worked across South languages and recently ventured into Hindi films, saw their ranks rise. Mandanna wowed in Telugu relationship horror *The Girlfriend* late last year, while Pallavi and Nayanthara had a relatively low-key year with just one release each. The surprise inclusion here is actor and BJP MP Kangana Ranaut, especially since her acting career has taken a back seat as theatrics in the Lok Sabha take precedence. It didn't help that her Indira Gandhi act in *Emergency* misfired miserably at the box office.

NEW STREAMERS

On the OTT front, both the male and female categories saw the rise of a new king and queen. Ravi Kishan polled better than OTT stars Nawazuddin Siddiqui, Manoj Bajpayee, Bobby Deol and Anil Kapoor, an impressive accomplishment given that both Bajpayee (*The Family Man*) and Deol (*Aashram, The Ba***ds of Bollywood*) had releases in 2025 while Kishan has been riding on the adulation he received for Netflix series *Mamla Legal Hai* and his beloved turn in *Laapataa Ladies*, both 2024 titles. Among the actresses, Madhuri Dixit-Nene's turn as a cold, calculating serial killer in JioStar series, *Mrs Deshpande*, clearly resonated, with the star faring much better than Raveena Tandon, Sonali Bendre, Neena Gupta and Samantha Ruth Prabhu. ■

No. 1
Sonu Nigam has replaced Arijit Singh as the top singer for the first time